



Imagine a bird soaring high above the water, with a wingspan wider than you are tall. That's a pelican for you! These large and somewhat goofy-looking birds have a distinctive pouch under their beaks, which they use for catching food. Their feather colors can vary from white, brown, or gray, and they have short legs with webbed feet perfect for swimming. There are eight different species of pelicans, and they can be found all around the world.

Now, let's dive into the fascinating world of what pelicans eat and where they live. Pelicans are great fishermen and mostly eat fish, but they'll also snack on amphibians, crustaceans, and on rare occasions, smaller birds. They live in coastal areas, near lakes and rivers, and they are social creatures often seen in large flocks. Pelicans are well adapted to their aquatic homes with their long beaks and large throat pouches to scoop up their meals.

You must be curious about the life cycle of these large birds and their relationships with other animals and humans. Pelicans usually live up to 15 to 25 years, and they begin to breed when they are three or four years old. They are generally peaceful birds but can become aggressive if they feel their nests are threatened. Pelicans are generally unafraid of humans and have been known to snatch food from unsuspecting people!



Before we wrap up, let's look at some cool facts and defenses of these amazing birds. One of the most interesting things about pelicans is their large beak and throat pouch, which they use as a net to catch fish. They also have a hard layer of feathers that protect them from the sun and help them float in the water. So, next time you see a pelican, remember these fun facts about their lives and their important role in the ecosystem.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) Where can pelicans be found?
A. All around the world
B. Only in deserts
C. Only in polar regions
D. Only in rainforests
- 2) What are some animals that pelicans eat?
A. Amphibians, crustaceans, and smaller birds
B. Lions, elephants, and giraffes
C. Mammals, reptiles, and insects
D. Worms, snails, and plants
- 3) How many species of pelicans are there?
A. Eight.
B. Five.
C. Twenty.
D. Ten.
- 4) How long do pelicans usually live?
A. 30 to 40 years.
B. 50 to 60 years.
C. 15 to 25 years.
D. 5 to 10 years.
- 5) What colors can the feathers of a pelican be?
A. Purple, pink, or teal
B. Red, green, or blue
C. Yellow, orange, or black
D. White, brown, or gray
- 6) What do pelicans use their pouch for?
A. For flying.
B. For storing water.
C. For catching food.
D. For making sounds.
- 7) What do pelicans usually eat?
A. Plants.
B. Mice.
C. Fish.
D. Insects.
- 8) Where do pelicans generally live?
A. Mountains and deserts
B. Above the tree line
C. Coastal areas, near lakes, and rivers
D. Far from water bodies
- 9) What can pelicans snatch from unsuspecting humans?
A. Money
B. Food
C. Shiny objects
D. Clothes
- 10) From what age do pelicans start breeding?
A. When they are born
B. At one year old
C. At seven or eight years old
D. Three or four years old
- 11) Where is a pelican's pouch?
A. On their stomach
B. They do not have any pouch
C. On their back
D. Under their beak

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 12) "I only live in the United States."
- 13) "I only live around deserts."
- 14) "I am a great fisherman; fish is my favorite food."
- 15) "I'm the smallest bird in the world."
- 16) "I don't usually live long, maybe about 5 years."

- 17) "I don't ever eat amphibians and crustaceans, only fish."
- 18) "My beak is not for show, it functions like a fishing net to scoop up my meals."
- 19) "You won't believe it, but I've been known to steal food from unsuspecting humans!"
- 20) "I'm not always the same color, I can be white, brown, or gray depending on my kind."
- 21) "My beak is too small to catch any meals."
- 22) "I prefer eating fruits and veggies."
- 23) "We pelicans are usually very aggressive."
- 24) "You'll usually find me near the sea, lakes, or rivers. I love the coastal areas!"
- 25) "I love a solitary life, away from other pelicans."
- 26) "My wing span can be between 6 and 12 feet tall!"
- 27) "We pelicans might seem calm, but if you venture near our nests, you might see our aggressive side."
- 28) "As a pelican, I live up to 25 years, much longer than some of the other birds!"
- 29) "I don't really like the water, I prefer to stay on land."
- 30) "I use the pouch under my beak like a bucket to catch dinner!"
- 31) "I mostly eat fish, but I might chomp on frogs or crab too."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 32) Pelicans can live up to 25 years.
- 33) The way pelicans catch fish with their big pouch is amazing.
- 34) There are eight different species of pelicans all around the world.
- 35) Pelicans are the coolest birds because they can fly, swim, and dive.
- 36) Pelicans can be white, brown, or gray in color.
- 37) It's amazing to see pelicans gliding above the water.
- 38) Pelicans may get aggressive if they feel their nests are in danger.
- 39) Pelicans have a large pouch under their beaks.
- 40) Pelicans' short legs and webbed feet make them look cute.
- 41) Pelicans look funny with their large beaks and wide wingspan.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 42) Pelicans can live for up to 25 years.
- 43) Pelicans only live 3 years.
- 44) Pelicans may eat smaller birds.
- 45) All pelicans are white.
- 46) Pelicans use their large beak and throat pouch as a net to catch fish.
- 47) Pelicans only eat fish.
- 48) Pelicans start to have babies when they are one year old.
- 49) Pelicans are loners and prefer to avoid other pelicans.
- 50) Pelicans have been observed snatching food from people.
- 51) Pelicans live all around the world.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.

- 52)** I'm sure you've seen a pelican at the beach, they're quite common there.
- A. you are B. you were
C. you will D. you have

- 53) Pelicans won't eat fish that are not fresh.
A. cannot
B. doesn't
C. do not
D. will not
- 54) Pelicans don't build nests in trees.
A. should not
B. do
C. are not
D. do not
- 55) It's amazing how pelicans can hold more fish in their beak than their belly.
A. They are
B. We are
C. It has
D. It is
- 56) Pelicans can't fly as high as eagles, but they are still impressive.
A. will not
B. can
C. cannot
D. are not
- 57) Did you know that they're one of the largest birds capable of flight?
A. they were
B. they will
C. they are
D. they have

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 58) Pelicans are social birds and often live in colonies with other pelicans.
- 59) A group of pelicans is called a pod, now that's astonishing!
- 60) Pelicans can live up to 25 years in the wild, how fantastic is that!
- 61) Fascinatingly, pelicans can eat up to four pounds of fish a day!
- 62) Imagine this, the wings of a pelican can spread as wide as 10 feet, that's larger than any human!
- 63) Pelicans use their beak to scoop up fish from the water.
- 64) Are pelicans social birds?
- 65) Can you believe it, a pelican's beak can hold up to three gallons of water!
- 66) Pelican chicks are born without feathers and rely on their parents for food and protection.
- 67) How do pelicans catch fish?
- 68) Pelican chicks can eat up to 3 lbs of fish a day, now that's a hungry baby bird!
- 69) How big are pelicans?
- 70) Isn't it amazing, brown pelicans are the smallest of all pelican species but they are still one of the heaviest birds that can fly!
- 71) Pelicans don't store food in their pouch, instead, they use it to scoop up fish before swallowing them whole, how wild is that!
- 72) Pelicans live on every continent except for Antarctica, it's amazing!
- 73) Did you know, pelicans fly low over water using updrafts from the waves to help them fly, that is incredible!



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|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | 67. _____ |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | 68. _____ |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | 69. _____ |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | 70. _____ |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | 71. _____ |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | 72. _____ |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | 73. _____ |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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1.	A	26.	Would	51.	true
2.	A	27.	Would	52.	D
3.	A	28.	Would	53.	D
4.	C	29.	Not	54.	D
5.	D	30.	Would	55.	D
6.	C	31.	Would	56.	C
7.	C	32.	fact	57.	C
8.	C	33.	opinion	58.	declarative
9.	B	34.	fact	59.	exclamatory
10.	D	35.	opinion	60.	exclamatory
11.	D	36.	fact	61.	exclamatory
12.	Not	37.	opinion	62.	exclamatory
13.	Not	38.	fact	63.	declarative
14.	Would	39.	fact	64.	interrogative
15.	Not	40.	opinion	65.	exclamatory
16.	Not	41.	opinion	66.	declarative
17.	Not	42.	true	67.	interrogative
18.	Would	43.	false	68.	exclamatory
19.	Would	44.	true	69.	interrogative
20.	Would	45.	false	70.	exclamatory
21.	Not	46.	true	71.	exclamatory
22.	Not	47.	false	72.	exclamatory
23.	Not	48.	false	73.	exclamatory
24.	Would	49.	false		
25.	Not	50.	true		